SOLID, LIQUID, AND GAS

"THE STATES OF YOUR WELLBEING MATTER MORE THAN ANYTHING..."

CREATED BY DAVID QUANG PHAM

LOGLINE

A struggling educator must reinvent herself by winning the host role of a beloved children's tv show, only to face the original host's legacy and a public resistant to inclusivity.

SYNOPSIS

Solid, Liquid, and Gas is a comedy-drama series inspired by children's programming where magical wonder, industry rivalry, and mental health challenges collide. Set in the late 2020s, the story follows Filipina American educator Ray Reyes, after being fired from a theatre, who tries to seize the mantle of the revival of *Stardust*, a beloved interactive children's tv show. To succeed, Ray must contend with former host Clay, popular science host Ms. Aurora, the public's distrust of inclusivity, and her tendency to go from being a ray of sunshine to fireballs under pressure. The states of matter are used as a metaphor for everyone's personal transformations.

RAY - TRINI REYES

OLDER SIS/SCIENCE COMMUNICATOR/PUPPETEER

Driven by a lifelong passion for science and childhood love for the show *Stardust*, this Filipina American struggling theatre performer fights to be the host of the revival, *StarPower!* She often breaks the fourth wall to speak directly to the camera, sharing cynical thoughts about the world or asking viewers to make a choice. She can speak Tagalog.

KWAN REYES

Ray's younger brother, an astronomy grad student at Michigan State University and a member of a neurodivergent theatre. Due to *Stardust*, he is an astronomy prodigy.

MS. AURORA STERLING -plasma-

A world-renowned science communicator and the host of *StarPower!* She sings, plays many instruments, and speaks multiple languages. She is overtly vocal on social issues. As a rival, her talking head buds with Ray's head.

BILLY CLAYTON DUBOIS -solid-

The original host of *Stardust*. He left in 2006 due to clinical depression. He often talks to thin air.

RIVER MATTHEWS -liquid-

The creator of *Stardust* and its revival *StarPower!* She voices Stardust. As a major player in children's programming, she cannot stand Ray.

SCHUYLER 'SKYE' PARK -gas-

A co-creator of *Stardust* and voice actor of many of its characters. They are an ally of Ray.

STARDUST + STARPOWER (a show within a show) 🌠

A Mac and Cheese Network (MCN) franchise created by River Matthews and Skye Park. It combines concepts from child development and early childhood education with animation and cardboard to help their viewers learn. The series was originally hosted by Billy Clayton Dubois as Clay, who left in 2006 leading to its cancellation until being replaced by Ms. Aurora Sterling as Aurora for the 2026 reboot.

STARDUST (1999–2006) follows Stardust, an animated cosmic mudpuppy, as she leaves glittery trails to help Clay and the viewers navigate a planet they are visiting.

STARPOWER! (2026–2029) follows Stardust's bigger axolotl sister, StarPower, who uses her powers with the help of Stardust, her explorer friends (Aurora and sidekick Ray), and viewers to save planets in trouble.

STARDUST + STARPOWER – Characters (show in a show)

STARDUST (voiced by River Matthews) is a cosmic green mudpuppy who leave glitter for her space explorer friends to find their way through the planets they are visiting.

STARPOWER (voiced by River Matthews) is a cosmic pink axolotl and Stardust's bigger sister who uses her powers to help worlds in trouble.

CLAY (played by Billy Clayton Dubois) is the host of the first show. In the reboot, he since has returned to his home planet, is a rocket scientist, and appears as a recurring character.

AURORA (played by Ms. Aurora) is the host of the revival series *StarPower!* and the second host of the franchise. She is Clay's younger cousin and a talented musician.

RAY (played by Trini Reyes) is Aurora's courageous sidekick of the revival series. She often gets sent to scout inconvenient places. She becomes the third host of the franchise.

ROCKET (voiced by Skye Park) is a cheerful green-and-white ship who transports Stardust and her friends to distant worlds.

TELESCOPE (voiced by Skye Park) is an insightful telescope.

SOLID

Represents rigid structures, childhood's perceived stability, or being stuck in one's ways (like Clay).

LIQUID

Represents transition, the messy middle ground of a career or life (like River)

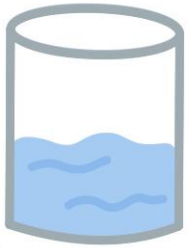
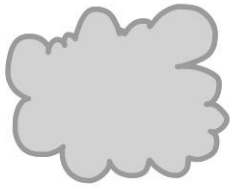
GAS

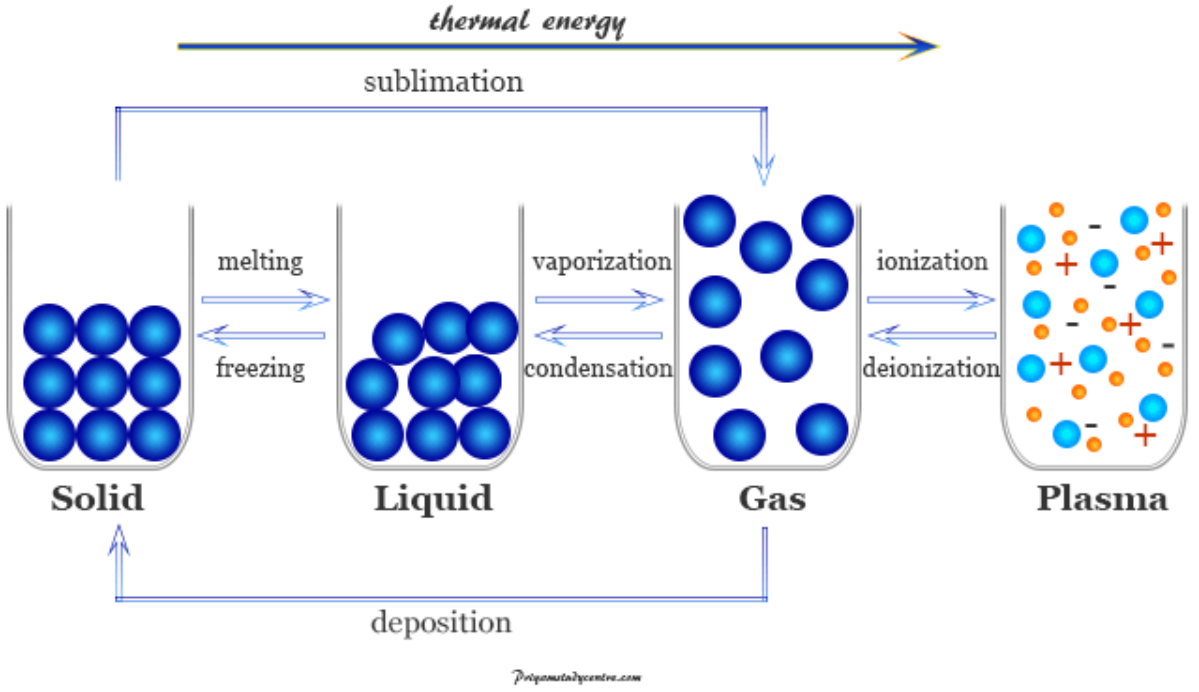
Represents spreading out, reaching a wider audience of all cultures/genders (like Skye), or evaporation of facts in a truthless world

PLASMA

Represents freshness (like Aurora) and even what’s high-energy and unfiltered (like Ray)

The Different Phases of Matter

Solid	Liquid	Gas	Plasma
Holds its shape	 Shape conforms to container	 No distinct shape	No distinct shape
Examples: - Salt - Ice - Wood - Phone - Clothes	**Examples:** - Water - Mercury - Blood - Soda - Coffee	**Examples:** - Air - CO_2 - Helium - Oxygen - Propane	**Examples:** - Lightening - Aurora - Neon signs - Sun/stars - Nuclear Fireball



3 SEASONS

Season 1 (13 episodes) follows Trini “Ray” Reyes as she fights to become the new host of the revived children’s educational series *Stardust*, only to be sidelined by network politics and personal rivalries. The states of matter are used as a metaphor for personal transformation throughout the season.

Season 2 (9 episodes) shifts from Ray's struggle to become the host to her battle to keep this role amidst corporate pressure, mental health burnout, and a sabotage campaign by the original host.

Season 3 (5 episodes) focuses on the characters facing a future dominated by anti-science sentiment and political shifts, culminating in a unified stand for education.

27 EPISODES

Season 1: Solid

1. Inner Child → 2. Who Does Not Belong? → 3. Write and Wrong →
4. For Educational Purposes Only → 5. Autopilot → 6. Listening Ears → 7. A Safe World→
8. Won't You Be My Enemy? → 9. Sublime → 10. A Chain Reaction →
11. Save the Children → 12. The Boiling Point → 12. Outer Child

Season 2: Liquid

1. Back on Earth → 2. Burnout → 3. Hosts of War → 4. Loud on Set →
5. Community Guidelines → 6. We All Matter → 7. Unscripted → 8. Opening Night →
9. Wish for Granted

Season 3: Gas

1. Absolute Zero → 2. Solid → 3. Liquid → 4. Gas → 5. Plasma → 6. Prima Materia

SEASON 1 (Episode 1 - 5)

Ray, a struggling educator, finds inspiration from her childhood hero, *Stardust* host, Clay. She learns the show is being revived as *StarPower!*, but the creators plan to hire her rival, Ms. Aurora, without auditions. Her brother Kwan helps Ray reconnect with Clay. Initially turning her down, he decides to be her mentor upon finding out about the revival without his knowledge.

Amongst 3000 auditions, Ray performs well, but the network ultimately chooses the polished Ms. Aurora as the host. But due to public outcry, Ray is hired as a writer with a guest appearances as Aurora’s sidekick, which is designed to sideline her, leading to personality clashes on set.

Ray struggles to adapt to the show's rigid format, having a hard time pausing for children's responses. But she refines her hosting style after realizing her direct approach resonates with neurodivergent viewers like her brother.

SEASON 1 (Episode 6 - 11)

An ideological rift forms when Aurora uses her platform to discuss climate change, while Ray is neutral on sensitive topics to stay on the network's good graces. The public sees Aurora as brave and Ray as a coward. Ray decides to be a guest appearance on a conservative children's show in an attempt to reach a challenging audience. This backfires, leading to a confrontation with a stressed progressive Aurora and Ray's eventual firing by the network.

The network brings back Clay as a recurring character, but Aurora suspects he plans to undermine her. Meanwhile, Ray volunteers at her brother's neurodivergent theatre, learning humility and that her role is to support others and to *listen*. Aurora goes on strike and forces the network to rehire Ray, though Ray opts to simply return as a writer.

SEASON 1 (Episode 12 - 13)

Following their shared ordeal, Ray and Aurora reconcile and become friends. Ray celebrates turning 30 and crashes her car much like Clay on his 29th birthday. This time, Skye takes the blame and gets suspended from the show. Just before the first season finale begins filming, Aurora accepts the host position of *Science* and quits *StarPower!* The co-creators, River and Skye, are about to pull the plug, but Ray returns to take the mantle.

Ray hosts her first solo episode for the season finale, by a crowd of anti-science protesters gathered outside the studio. She masters the pause technique she previously struggled with, speaking her truth to the camera and receiving a positive response from children worldwide. Unknown to her, Clay is plotting to reclaim the hosting spot, and remove her with the show creators, setting up Ray as the active target of the next season.

SEASON 2 (Episode 1 - 6)

Ray debuts as the host of the second season of *StarPower!* to high ratings. However, things turn toxic when Clay returns as a consultant. He suggests to the network that she is cracking under pressure during a grueling filming schedule for both the show and a new feature film, *Star Goes to Earth*.

After a tabloid leaks a video of Ray and Aurora fighting at a children's media convention, their networks force them on a kindness press tour, where they become enemies again. Aurora discovers Clay is sabotaging Ray but allows it to continue as she is against *Stardust*'s network's political stances.

Harsh filming conditions and encounters with hostile anti-science activists cause Ray's mental state to spiral. After a fire on set that shakes Ray to her core, the network forces her to take a mental health break. In her absence, Clay hosts several hollow specials that cause viewership to drop.

SEASON 2 (Episode 7 - 9)

Ray finds an unreleased VHS tape showing Clay having a breakdown on set years ago. She confronts him, feeling he is sabotaging her because he fears her success would make his legacy obsolete.

Ray asks Aurora to return as herself on the film, *Star Goes to Earth*. She accepts and brings her musical talents. She also uses the film to advocate for the environment and wellbeing of children everywhere.

In the Season 3 premiere of *StarPower!*, a terminally ill child actor named Grant guest stars. Clay officially retires, passing his signature cosmic vest to Grant. Despite Grant's wish for the show to continue, the network abruptly cancels the series, leaving only five produced episodes for the final season. Ray announces this news on a book signing tour. Meanwhile, Kwan is given an opportunity to audition for an acclaimed science documentary series.

SEASON 3 (Episode 1 - 6)

Ray learns the *StarPower!* cancellation was due to the FCC's anti-science views. Years pass, with such sentiment growing in the nation's government.

Nearly a decade later in 2038, a natural disaster reunites the *Stardust* team as spokespersons. The nation faces massive education funding cuts. During a gathering in support of teachers, an anti-activist driver runs over Ms. Aurora, making the fight for science a matter of life and death.

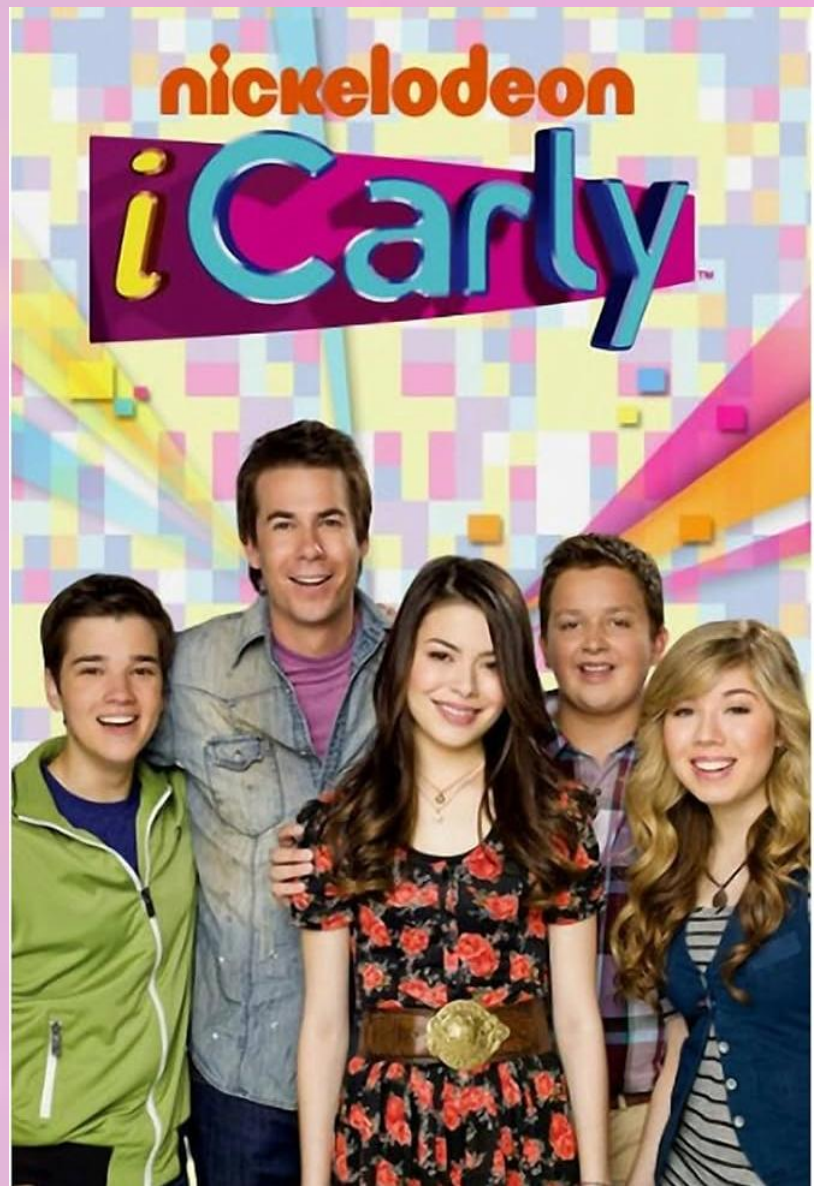
In 2039, Ray uses *Stardust*'s 40th anniversary to deliver an inspiring message about education. This message prompts thousands of adult *Stardust* fans to march on the capitol, demanding funding restoration. The series ends with Ray attending the premiere of a science series created by her brother, Kwan.

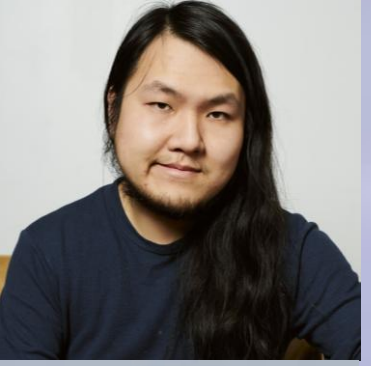
COMPS **Half-Hour Dramedy** **A bit Musical** **A bit Animated**

chaos of *The Bear* eats fun of *Blue's Clues* eats 4th wall breaks of *Fleabag*

COMPS2 Serialized Season 1 Episodic After Mockumentary

mockumentary of *Abbott* meets science of *Magic School Bus* meets slapstick of *iCarly*





Showrunner - Composer: DAVID QUANG PHAM

An award-winning songwriter, theatre and filmmaker who personifies science to explore social issues and the human condition. 2025 highlights include the world premiere of his musicals *Turnover: A New Leaf* and *Chemicals in the Water*, alongside film fellowships with Cinephila and Kellogg's Foundation. He is an astrophysics and theatre graduate from Michigan State.

Producer: SANNETTE GAIA

Sannette Gaia is an American producer and director. Hailing from Salem, OR, her love for visual and performing arts began at an early age. She began performing at the age of 11 on stage, subsequently writing local award-winning plays. [IMDB]

Director: TBD

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Film Team:

Director of Photography: TBD
Assistant Director: TBD
Sound Recordist: TBD
Production Coordinator: LEE PETROLL

Art Team:

Animation: LuckyJoy Studio -CEO BEMA COULIBALY
Character Design: TBD
Animators: TBD
Storyboard: TBD

WHY NOW?

We're living through a cultural moment. It's been 30 years since *Blue's Clues* premiered; this show changed how we processed the world thru kindness and listening. For many like me, Steve inspired us to see the universe as a puzzle we could solve, together. Steve's message in 2021 meant the world.

Today's generation is growing up in a world defined by scientific skepticism and distrust in education. *Solid, Liquid, and Gas* is my direct response to this.

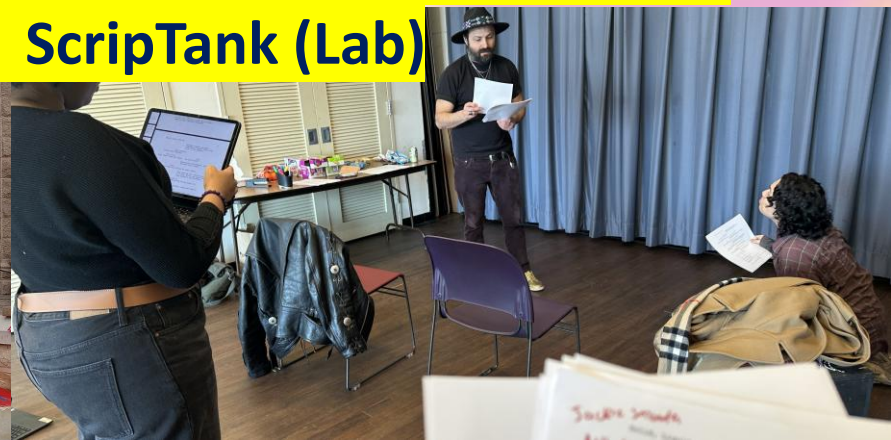
ACCOLADES 🏆

- 2026 Digital Dramaturgy Finalist

DEVELOPMENT

Mar '26 | Playwrights Horizon (Workshop)

'25 – ongoing | ScripTank (Lab)



AND IT'S JUST... IT'S
JUST SO AMAZING, RIGHT?

INSPIRATION

Since 2014, David Quang Pham is an active supporter of neurodivergent children's theatres like Openspot Theatre (once 4th Wall Theatre Company).

One of David's theatre professors (anonymous) was on the shortlist to host *Blue's Clues*. As of 2015, they are still upset about losing to Steve Burns.

David, VP of Michigan State's Sigma Pi Sigma chapter, physics honor society; and volunteer at Impression 5 Science Center.

David (7) at Space Camp, Huntsville, Alabama

A LITTLE SCIENTIST'S DREAM

Andrea M. Ghez, 2020 Nobel Prize in Physics
David studied in guest Dr. Ghez's class in 2015.

Let's Create the Universe Together

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Special Thanks to…

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